Dire Beginnings

Questbook A:
Crownfall

Enemy Token Overview

Schematic Token	Enemy & Supply Limit
	Beast (5)
	Corrupted (5)
	Critters (5)
	Goblin (8)
	Undead (5)
	Wraith (4)
	Bandit (5)
	Nameless Demon (3)
	Orc (5)

Schematic Token	Enemy & Supply Limit
	Blackguard (2)
	Evil Wizard (4)
	Living Armor (4)
	Succubus (2)
	Fallen Hero (4)
	Giant Spider (2)
	Arch Demon (2)
	Ogre (2)

Adventure Overview

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Foreword

This first questbook is designed as a gentle introduction to Dire Beginnings. Its early adventures give you time to familiarize yourself with the game's mechanics, experiment with your chosen hero, and get comfortable with the flow of play.

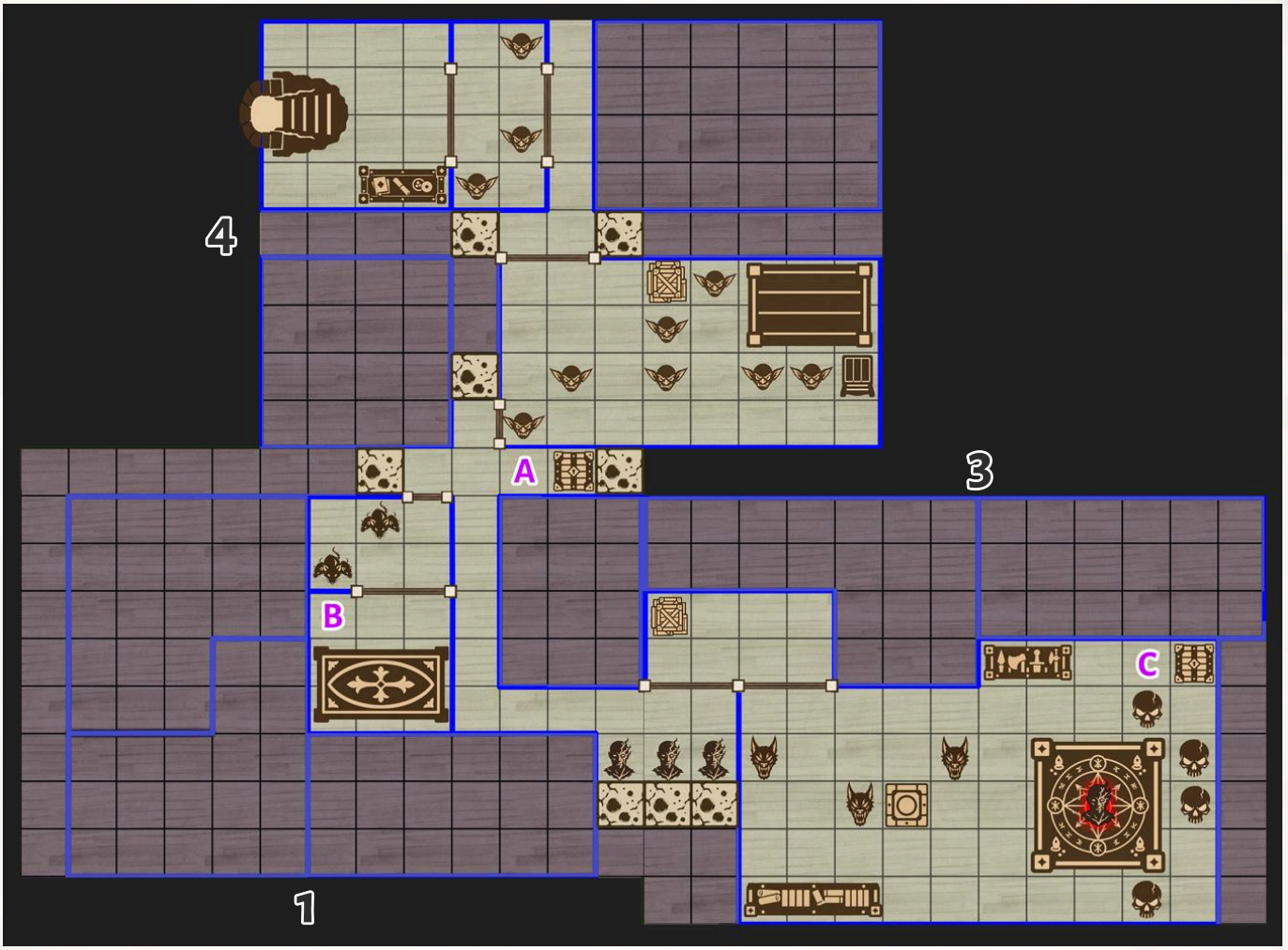
The first adventure, "The Strange Sorcerer," is intentionally very easy. Don't let that fool you into thinking the entire game will be a walk in the park! The difficulty gradually increases, and by Adventure 4, you'll be facing the full challenge that Dire Beginnings has to offer. If your party still finds the game too easy at that point, consider increasing the difficulty level.

You'll also notice that this questbook is relatively light on storytelling. This is intentional, as I want you to experience the core gameplay first, without slowing things down with lengthy narrative passages. After all, the most important thing is finding out whether Dire Beginnings is a game you enjoy playing!

Later questbooks place a greater emphasis on storytelling, with more opportunities to immerse yourself in the world and its characters.

Adventure 1A: The Strange Sorcerer

Starting Doom Clock: 15
Resurrection Boons: 1



Intro

Brave adventurers, unease has fallen upon our beloved realm Drucavia.

In recent nights, strange lights have torn across the sky, and foul magic has begun to seep into the land. Crops wither without cause, shadows twist where no fire burns, and frightened villagers whisper of things that should not be.

King Arnewald has called upon you to uncover the truth. His scouts have discovered the hideout of a sinister sorcerer by the name Alvus Thurweed, believed to be connected to these unnatural signs.

You must enter his lair, defeat his servants, and capture Alvus if possible. The king demands answers, and the realm grows darker with every passing night.

Objective

The boss Alvus Thurweed (A Corrupted) in the last room needs to be defeated.

Rewards

Stars	Requirement	XP Reward	Gold Reward
★★★	Doom Clock at 5+ upon completion.	5	90
★★	Doom Clock at 1+ upon completion.	4	80
★	Adventure completed.	4	60

Adventure Overview

- A -

The treasure contains 20 gold coins.

- B -

An alive farmer was put into the sarcophagus for a later blood sacrifice. The sarcophagus can be opened to free the farmer. He then becomes a minion with **5 Health**, **2d6 Offense**, and **7 Speed**.

- C -

You enter a damp room brimming with foul magic. A gaunt sorcerer kneels within a chalk circle, its lines glowing faintly red. As the door creaks open, he turns toward you and lets out a guttural command. His dogs snarl, and the summoned undead lurch forward to attack.

The treasure chest contains a Healing Potion and 10 gold coins.

The Undead in this room have the **Skeletons and Dangerous traits**.

The Corrupted in this room is the sorcerer of the quest: **Alvus Thurweed**. If he is defeated, the quest is completed.
He is a **boss** and has the **Armored and Skilled traits**. He has **15 Health**.

The minor ability of his reference card is overridden by:
Vile Sorcery - at the end of his turn, roll a d6:

1 He targets the most fatigued hero within Range 5 with a Defiling Curse, causing Blast 1.
2-3 He targets the furthest hero within Range 6 with Shocks, causing 1 Fatigue.
4-6 He sacrifices the most damaged Undead nearby, then heals himself by 5.

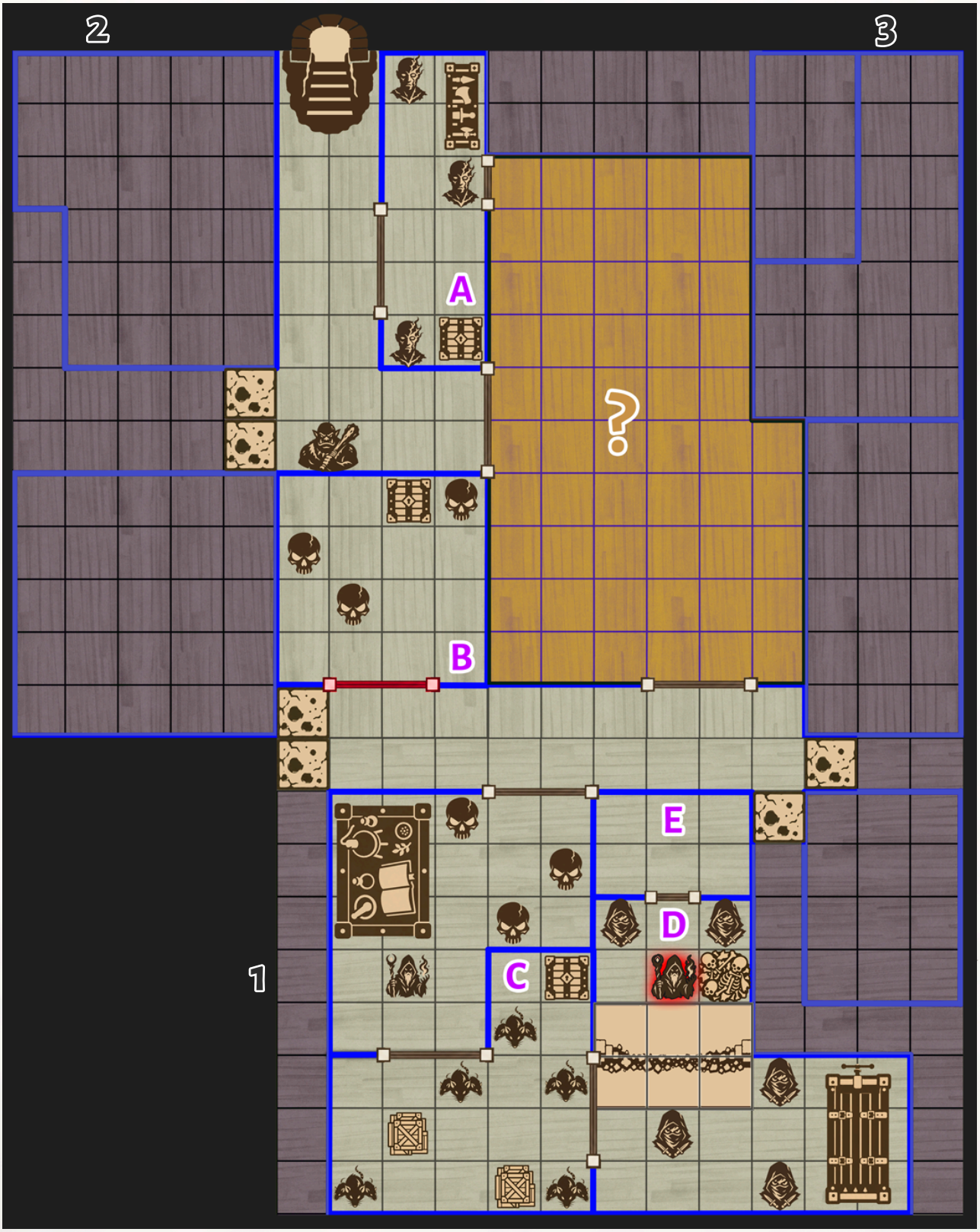
Outro

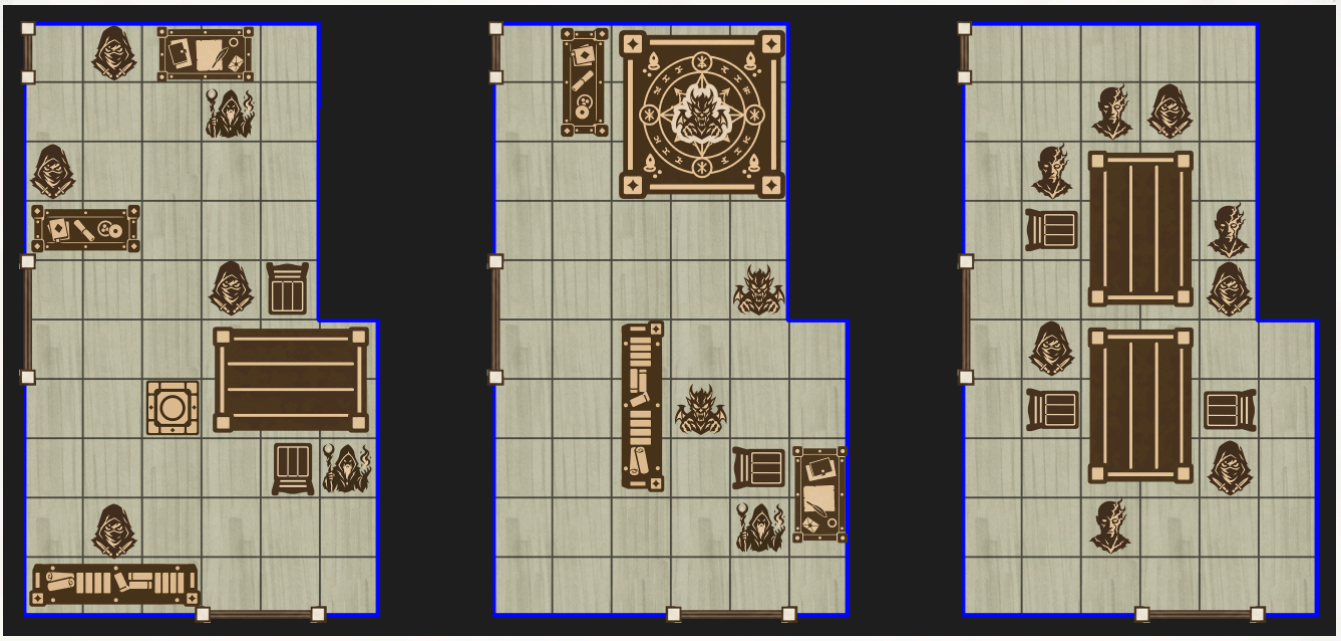
Alvus collapses without a sound, as if accepting his fate. For a brief moment, a faint smile crosses his lips as his head strikes the floor.

Was this all some kind of ruse? Only the king's house mages may know what it means. For now, you must bring the sorcerer's body back to the castle.

Adventure 2A: The King's House Mage

Starting Doom Clock: 15
Resurrection Boons: 1





Intro

The realm trembles beneath strange and dreadful signs.

Unnatural lights scar the night sky, and fear spreads through the villages. Even the king's court has not been spared. In the chaos, one of King Arnewald's own house mages, Sitilius Morcant, vanished before he could reveal what he had learned from your most recent findings.

The king believes Sitilius may hold vital knowledge about the dark events now unfolding across the land. His scouts have followed the trail to an abandoned holdfast, where foul creatures and shady figures have gathered in secret.

Enter the ruins, uncover the truth, and rescue the mage if he still lives. Arnewald needs his wisdom before darkness takes firmer root.

Objective

The House Mage needs to be freed from his cell, then he needs to get his belongings.
If the House Mage is defeated, the adventure ends as soon as all remaining enemies have been killed. In this case, Sitilius is gravely injured but alive...

Rewards

Stars	Requirement	XP Reward	Gold Reward
★★★	Doom Clock at 5+ upon completion and Sitilius survived.	5	110
★★	Doom Clock at 1+ upon completion and Sitilius survived.	5	95
★	Doom 0 or Sitilius was defeated.	4	85

Adventure Overview

- A -

The treasure contains a random item. Roll 1d6:

1-2: 10 Gold Coins
3-5: Rejuvenation Elixir & Restoration Potion
6: Militia Crossbow or 45 Gold Coins (choose)

- B -

The door to this chamber is locked. The key needs to be found to open it.
When this door is opened, an ambush happens. Spawn 3 Bandits as close as possible to Sitilius. The chest in this room contains his belongings. Sitilius can collect them by being adjacent at the end of his turn and by forfeiting his attack. If that happens AND all remaining enemies are defeated, he can safely escape and the adventure ends.

- C -

The treasure chest contains a relic: Chipped Sword (Oathbound).

- D -

The Evil Wizard in this room is a **boss**, and he has: The **Legendary, Penetrating and Multi-Attack traits**, and **20 Health**.
If he dies, he drops the key to Sitilius' prison cell as well as the chamber in "B". The key is automatically considered to be collected by the party.

- E -

The key from the boss in "D" is required to open this door. When opening, read the following text aloud:
You unlock the door to a small prison cell streaked with mold. In the corner, a weary mage in the unmistakable robes of King Arnewald's court looks up. He rises with sudden, newfound vigor.
"About time someone came to rescue me. You did well. I had important tomes with me when I was taken, and they are crucial to my mission. Help me find them, then we leave this place."

Sitilius is a minion with **20 Health**, **5 Speed** and **3d6 Offense** with **Range 5**.
Use a suitable hero miniature that is not in use to represent Sitilius.

Outro

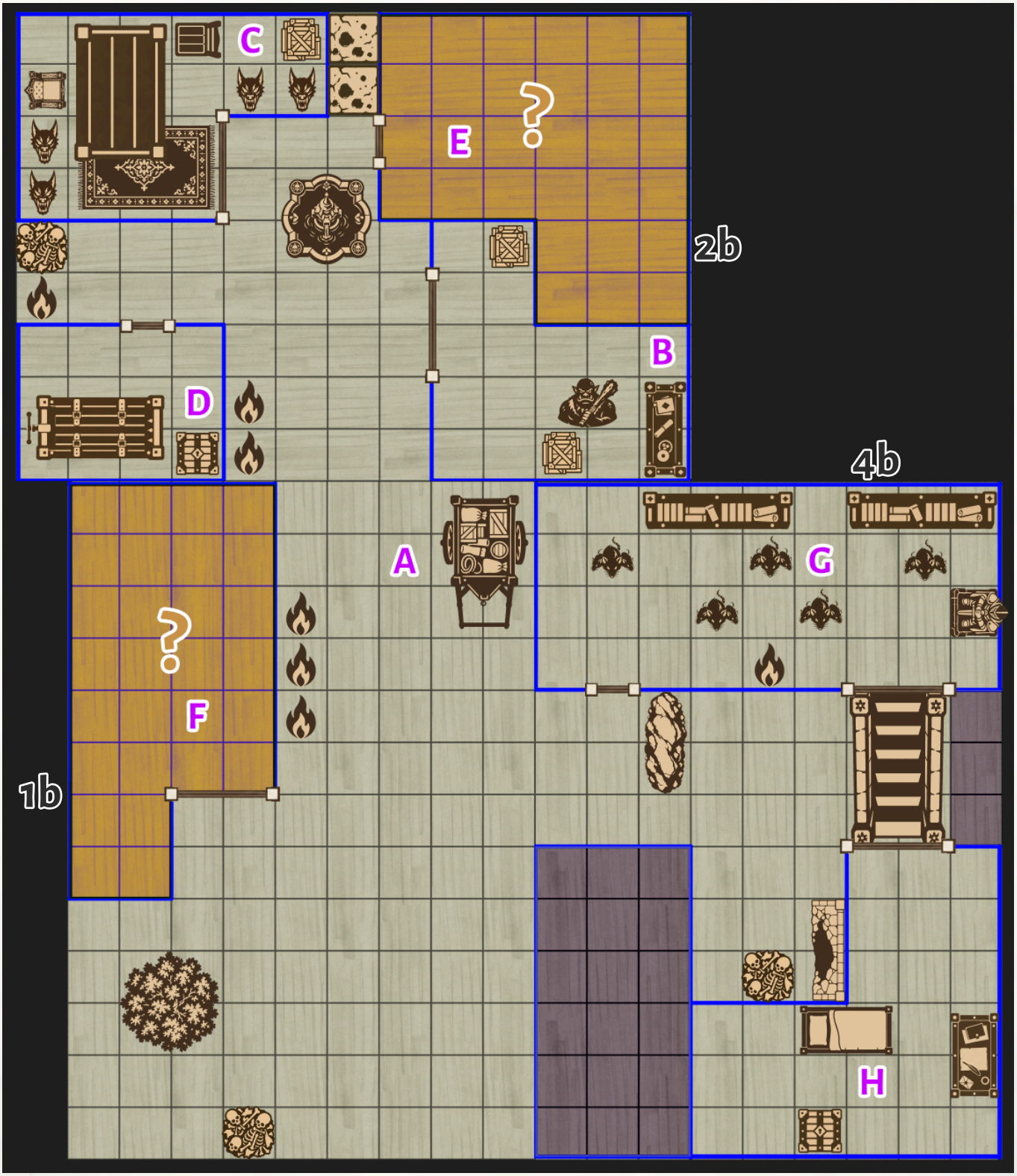
Sitilius gathers his recovered tomes with trembling hands, yet his voice is steady.

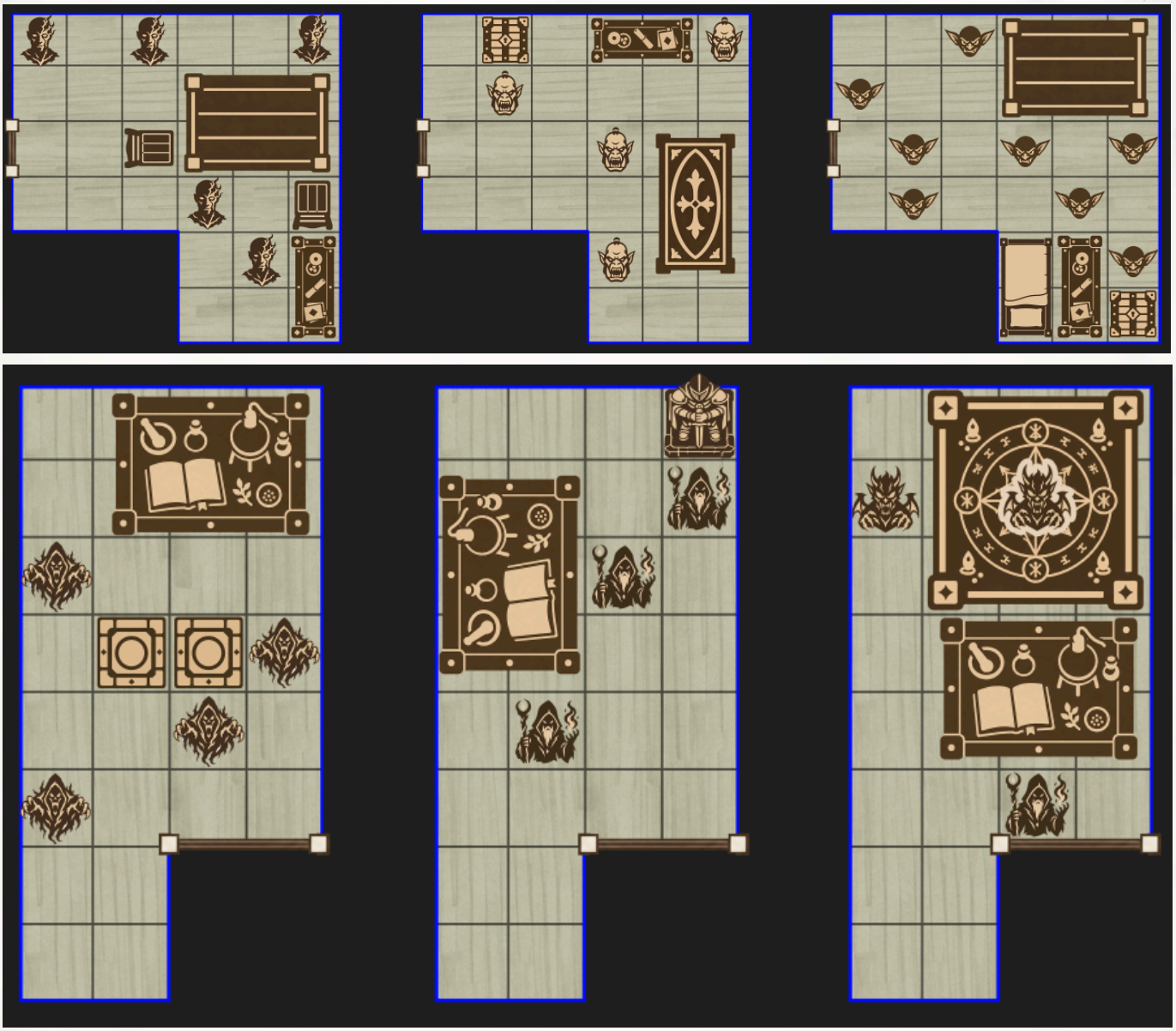
"These writings confirm what I feared. The signs in the sky are no accident."

He refuses to say more until you return to King Arnewald's court. As you leave the holdfast, a cold wind follows you through the broken gate.

Adventure 3A: The Stolen Village

Starting Doom Clock: 12
Resurrection Boons: 2





Intro

The darkness has reached the village of Veyrbruck.

Sitilius, King Arnewald's own house mage, has confirmed that an age-old evil may have returned to our lands. Veyrbruck was not merely a village, but a secret place of arcane study. Its scholars may have gathered vital clues before the village fell.
King Arnewald has ordered that nothing of value be left behind. You must escort the surviving villagers back into Veyrbruck and protect them while they recover research documents, rare instruments, and any knowledge that may help the realm understand the horrors now spreading across the land.

But one man remains unaccounted for: Lord Archivist Malrec Vane. Some believe he fled to his tower chamber and sealed himself inside. Enter the fallen village, guard the villagers, and recover what must not be lost.
If the archivist still lives, bring him back before the enemy claims him.

Objective

All four records must be recovered by the villagers and be brought back to the cart.
If all villagers die, the adventure is lost, and no reward is given.

Starting Condition

Place all heroes adjacent to the cart, as well as 3 villagers. The cart is considered the “dungeon entrance” for all considerations where it matters.

Special Mechanic - Undead Intruders

At the beginning of each round, roll 1d6, then determine one of the three bone piles through this.
1-2: Bone Pile in the top left.
3-4: Bone Pile in the bottom left.
5-6: Bone Pile in the bottom right.

Spawn one **Undead** (with the **Zombies and Penetrating traits**) **on** that Bone Pile - normally models cannot be placed on low props, so this is an exception to that rule.
If the supply of Undead is used up, spawn no additional Undead.

Special Mechanic - Record Retrieval

The three villagers are minions - each hero may claim one of these. They have **8 Health**, **5 Speed** and **2d6 Offense**. Instead of attacking, they can collect a record they are adjacent to, or drop a record they hold onto the cart when they are adjacent to it.
Each villager can only hold one record at a time. If a villager dies, drop the objective token that represents the record on their last location.

Rewards

Stars	Requirement	XP Reward	Gold Reward
★★★	All villagers survived AND Malrec Vane was rescued	5	120
★★	All villagers survived OR Melrec Vane was rescued	4	100
★	At least one villager survived	3	80

Adventure Overview

- A -

This is the cart. Villagers can drop off records here. As soon as all four records have been put on the cart, the adventure ends. The party may choose not to end the adventure immediately if Malrec Vane has been revealed but not yet rescued.

- B -

Place an objective token on the shelf which represents records.
The enemies in this room get the **Counter Attack and Enduring traits**.

- C -

Place an objective token on the crates which represents records.

- D -

The treasure chest in this room contains 20 gold coins.

- E -

Place an objective token on the shelf which represents records.
The enemies in this room get the **Ranged trait**.
If there is a treasure chest here, it contains Throwing Daggers (Wind-Touched, Honed).

- F -

Place an objective token anywhere on the alchemy table which represents records.

- G -

The enemies in this room get the **Legendary and Dangerous traits**.

- H -

You open the tower bedroom and find the floor littered with empty ration wrappers, torn notes, and spent candles. Behind an overturned bed crouches an old scholar in stained court robes, clutching a brass letter opener with trembling hands. "No closer," he rasps. "I know what hunts this village."
Only when he sees the king's seal does he lower the blade.
"Malrec Vane," he whispers. "Still alive."

Archivist Malrec Vane is positioned exactly on the space of the letter. When his room is opened, he becomes a minion just like the villagers. He is only considered rescued when he is adjacent to the cart when the adventure ends.
The treasure chest in this room contains a tome that grants one hero of the party's choice **+1 XP** after the adventure concludes.

Outro

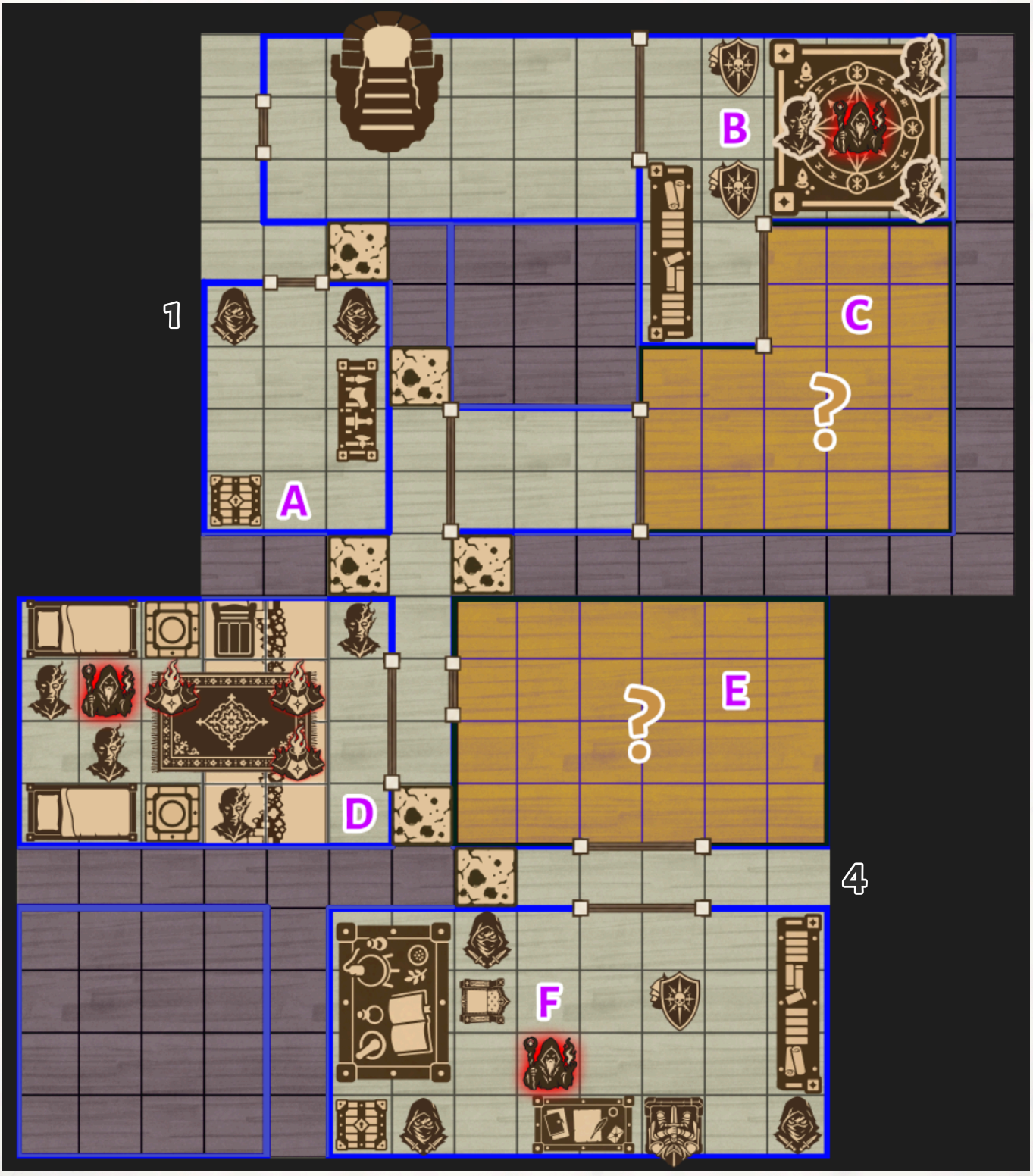
Smoke rises behind you as you lead the surviving villagers away from Veyrbruck. Flames consume the old homes, the hidden studies, and the last fragile traces of what the village once was.

What could be saved is carried in trembling hands: bundles of research records, cracked instruments, and sealed notes marked with the sigils of the court. The road back to King Arnewald's castle is quiet, broken only by the distant roar of the burning village.

At court, the recovered records are taken at once to Sitilius and the king's scholars. Their faces darken as they study the first pages. Whatever was uncovered in Veyrbruck, it points beyond the village, toward something ancient, deliberate, and far from finished.

Adventure 4a: The Mountain Rites

Starting Doom Clock: 12
Resurrection Boons: 1



Intro

King Arnewald stands before you in the war chamber, with recently recovered records from Veyrbruck spread across the table. His eyes remain fixed on the maps. "These findings confirm what I feared. A foul ritual is taking root in the northern mountains of Crownmoor."

He places a finger on a marked pass.
"You will go there. You will break the ritual. And every mage you find within those ruins is to be slain."

The chamber falls silent.

"No warnings. No bargains. No mercy for those who hide behind spellcraft while my realm bleeds." At last, the king looks up at you.
"Go north, heroes. End this before it becomes something we can no longer stop."

Objective

Defeat the three boss mages.

Rewards

Stars	Requirement	XP Reward	Gold Reward
★★★	Doom Clock at 1+ upon completion and the last mage was subdued and not killed.	5	145
★★	Doom Clock at 1+ upon completion and all mages killed, or alternatively the last mage was subdued.	4	130
★	All mages killed.	3	120

Adventure Overview

- A -

The treasure chest in this room contains “War Robes” (Mnemonic, Runescribed).

- B -

The chamber is lit by pale candles and a ring of red symbols carved into the stone floor. A robed mage kneels at its center, whispering words that make the air tremble.
Several attendants turn as you enter, fear flashing across their faces.
“The king’s men,” one of them gasps.
The mage does not rise. “Hold them back. The ward must not fail.”

The Corrupted in this room have the **Incompetent trait**.
They represent Peasants, and are therefore of the Human type, not Demon.

The Evil Wizard in this room is a **boss**, and he has: **Legendary trait** and **15 Health**.
The major ability of his reference card is overridden by:
Light Magic - at the end of his turn, roll a d6:

1-2 **Flash:** He teleports behind the furthest hero within Range 7 and performs an extra attack against them.
3-4 **Blinding Light:** He causes all heroes within Range 5 to lose 1 Stamina.
5-6 **Quick Heal:** He heals the most damaged other enemy within Range 5 by 3 Health.

When all enemies in this room are defeated, read aloud this text:
The ritual circle cracks. Its glow fades into the stone.
One of the attendants crawls toward the broken symbols, blood on his lips.
“What have you done?” he whispers. “We are all doomed now.”

- C -

The treasure chest in this room contains a scroll that immediately applies one **random Epic affix** to any one item within the party. Pull from the affixes pile until you drew an **Epic** affix, then apply it.

- D -

You enter a larger chamber where ragged figures huddle behind a line of armed knights. At the far end, a mage raises both hands, thin purple threads of magic stretching from his fingers to a bruised villager.
Chains hang from the walls, though many lie open on the floor.
One knight steps forward, blade raised. “You will not take them.”
The mage calls out, “Hold them back! The subjects must not be harmed!”

The Corrupted in this room have the **Incompetent trait**.
They represent Peasants, and are therefore of the Human type, not Demon.

The Evil Wizard in this room is a **boss**, and he has: **Legendary trait and 15 Health**.
The major ability of his reference card is overridden by:
Arcane Magic - at the end of his turn, roll a d6:

1-2 **Arcane Blade:** Move 3 towards the closest hero, then deals 8 Damage.
3-4 **Strengthen:** Causes the closest other enemy within Range 4 to draw 3 AI cards next turn,

and choose the one with the best initiative value.

5-6 **Arcane Missile:** Deals 4 Damage to each hero within hearing range.

When all enemies in this room are defeated, read aloud this text:
As the last defenders fall, one of the ragged survivors stares at you with hollow eyes.
"What kind of monsters hunt those who have already lost everything?"

- E -

If you roll the layout with the Corrupted, then they have the **Incompetent trait**.
They represent Peasants, and are therefore of the Human type, not Demon.

In either case, enemies in this room additionally gain the **Counter Attack trait**.

- F -

The final chamber reeks of bitter herbs, hot metal, and spilled alchemy. A frantic mage stands over a cracked vessel, while his assistants try to sweep glowing liquid back into a silver-lined trench.
"No, no, no," the mage mutters. "The outer ward is gone. It is reacting too soon."
The liquid boils black.
Something claws its way out of the smoke.
The mage staggers back, horrified. "Oh no."
As the demon pulls itself from the smoke, the mage does not laugh or command it. He stumbles back in terror, shouting for his assistants to run.

The party now has a choice: **kill the last mage or subdue him**. To subdue the mage, his final point of Health must be removed by an Unarmed Attack. If the mage is defeated by any other attack, he is killed. Only by subduing the mage can the party achieve a 3-star victory.

However, whatever the mage did, it went wrong. Roll 1d6:

1-2 Spawn **2 x Nameless Demo**n adjacent to the Mage.

3-4 Spawn a **Succubus** adjacent to the mage with the **Enduring trait**.

5-6 Spawn an **Arch Demon** adjacent to the Mage.

Demons are hostile to all figures in this room, including the mage and his associates. When determining targets, demons treat heroes, the mage, and his associates as viable targets.
The mage and his associates are also hostile to all demons. They may target heroes or demons according to normal targeting rules.

The Evil Wizard in this room is a **boss**, and he has: **Legendary trait and 15 Health**.
The major ability of his reference card is overridden by:
Alchemy Flasks - at the end of his turn, roll a d6:

1-2 **Fire Flask:** Targets the furthest target within Range 5 and creates a 1x1 fire token underneath them. They immediately lose 1 Health.

3-4 **Coughing Flask:** Targets the furthest target within Range 5 and causes Blast 3. Every hero who ends up losing Health from this also suffers 1 Fatigue.

5-6 **Acid Vial:** Targets the furthest target within Range 5 and causes them to lose 3 Health (no defense of toughness roll possible).

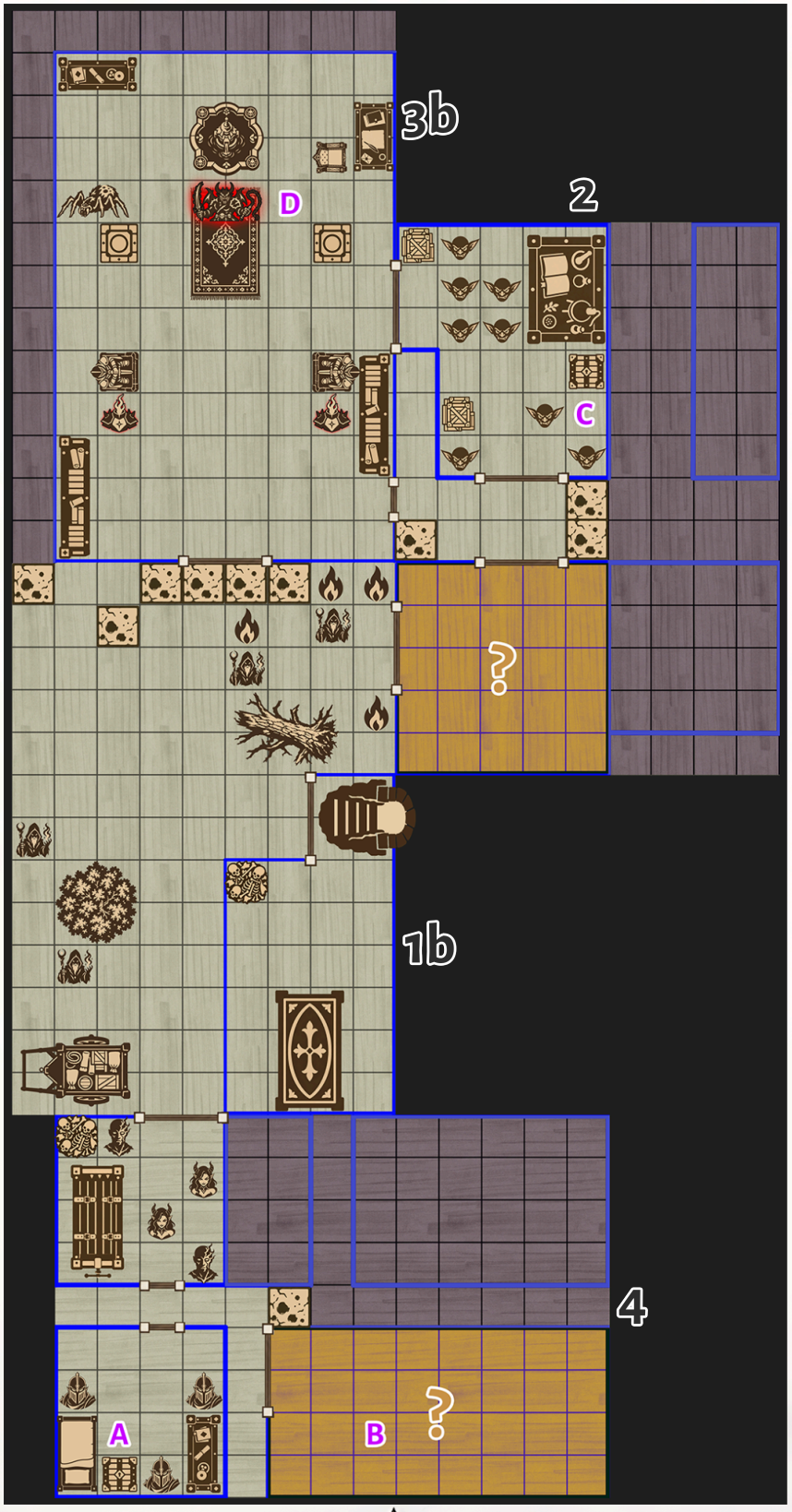
The treasure chest in this room contains **25 gold coins**.

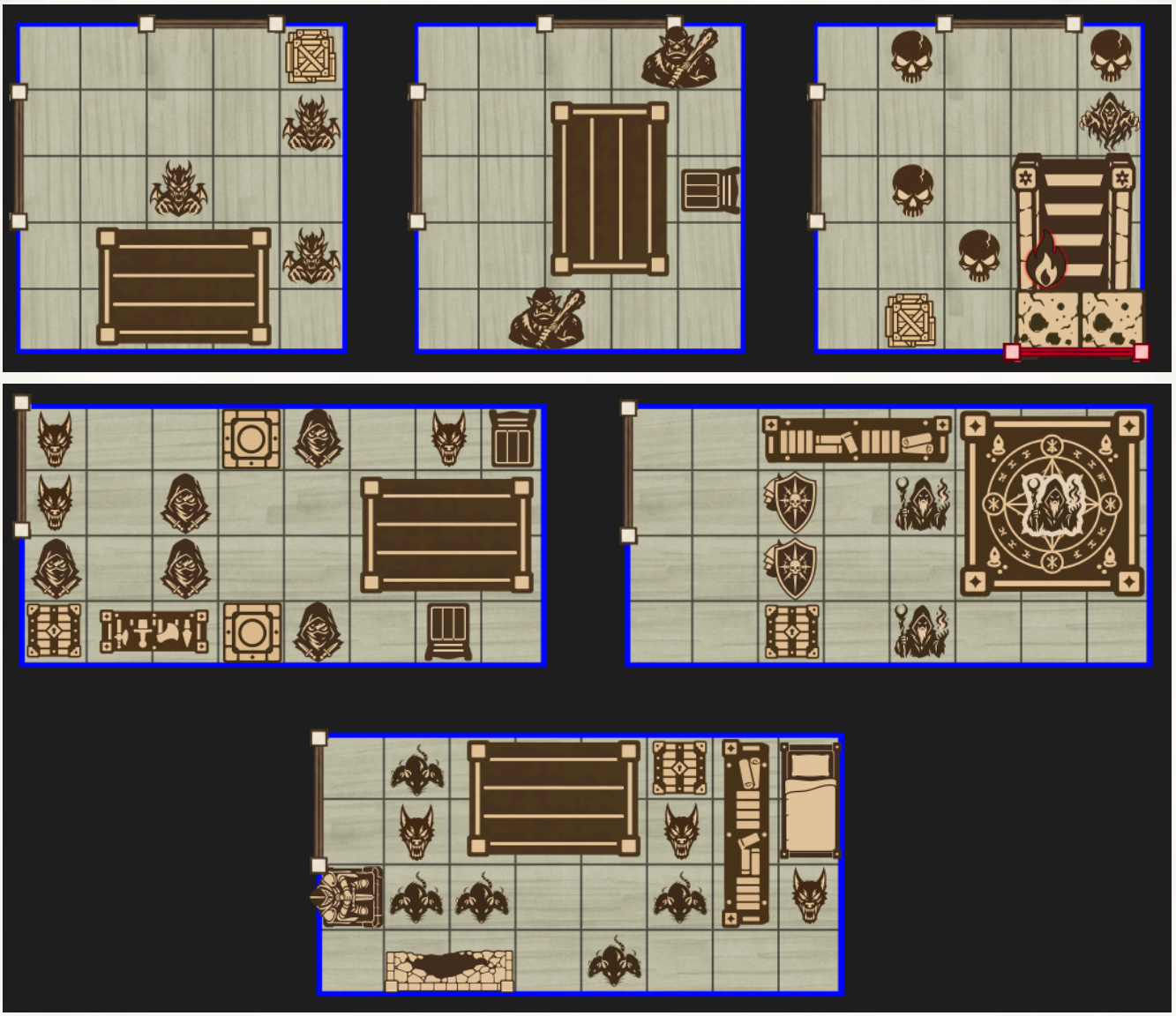
Outro

The last combatant falls, and silence returns to the ruined keep.
Among the broken vessels and scattered notes, you find records marked with the seal of King Arnewald's court.
They speak not of conquest or dark summoning, but of wards, barriers, and rituals meant to hold back the evil spreading through the mountains.
The mages here were not hiding from the king. They were working under his command.
As you leave the keep, the question follows you like a cold shadow: if these rituals were meant to protect the realm, why did Arnewald order them destroyed?

Adventure 5a: The Seer Stone

Starting Doom Clock: 12
Resurrection Boons: 1





Intro

Sitilius, one of King Arnewald's house mages, meets you away from the king's court, his voice low and troubled: "Reports and recovered records confirm what I feared... The king ordered the deaths of mages he believed to be evil, though they had been working for the realm all along." He pauses, glancing toward the castle halls. "And King Arnewald... is not quite himself. I cannot yet say why."

He tells you of the Seer Stone, an ancient relic of the realm said to reveal hidden truths and glimpses of unseen influence. Long ago, it was divided into three pieces and sealed within the Cathedral of Saint Venra. But the cathedral has fallen into a demon's hands.
"You must enter the cathedral, recover all three pieces, and bring them back to me," Sitilius says. "If something has taken hold of the king's mind, the Seer Stone may be our only chance to see it before it is too late."

Objective

Find all three fragments of the Seer Stone, and kill all enemies that are in the rooms that protect them.

Rewards

Stars	Requirement	XP Reward	Gold Reward
★★★	Doom Clock at 3+ upon completion.	4	160
★★	Doom Clock at 1+ upon completion.	4	140
★	All fragments found.	3	140

Adventure Overview

- A -

The treasure chest contains one **fragment of the Seer Stone**, as well as one **level 3 item**.
Draw items from the pile until you draw a level 3 item - skip consumables.

- B -

The treasure chest contains one **fragment of the Seer Stone**, as well as a **random Epic affix**.
Draw from the pile of affixes until you have two. Then choose one of the two affixes to apply it to an item of the party's choice.

- C -

The treasure chest contains **two consumables**. Draw cards from the pile until you have two consumables.

- D -

The Arch Demon in this room is a **boss**, and he has the following traits:

- **Venomous**
- **Sorcerous**
- **Counter Attack**
- **Skilled**

He has **50 Health**.

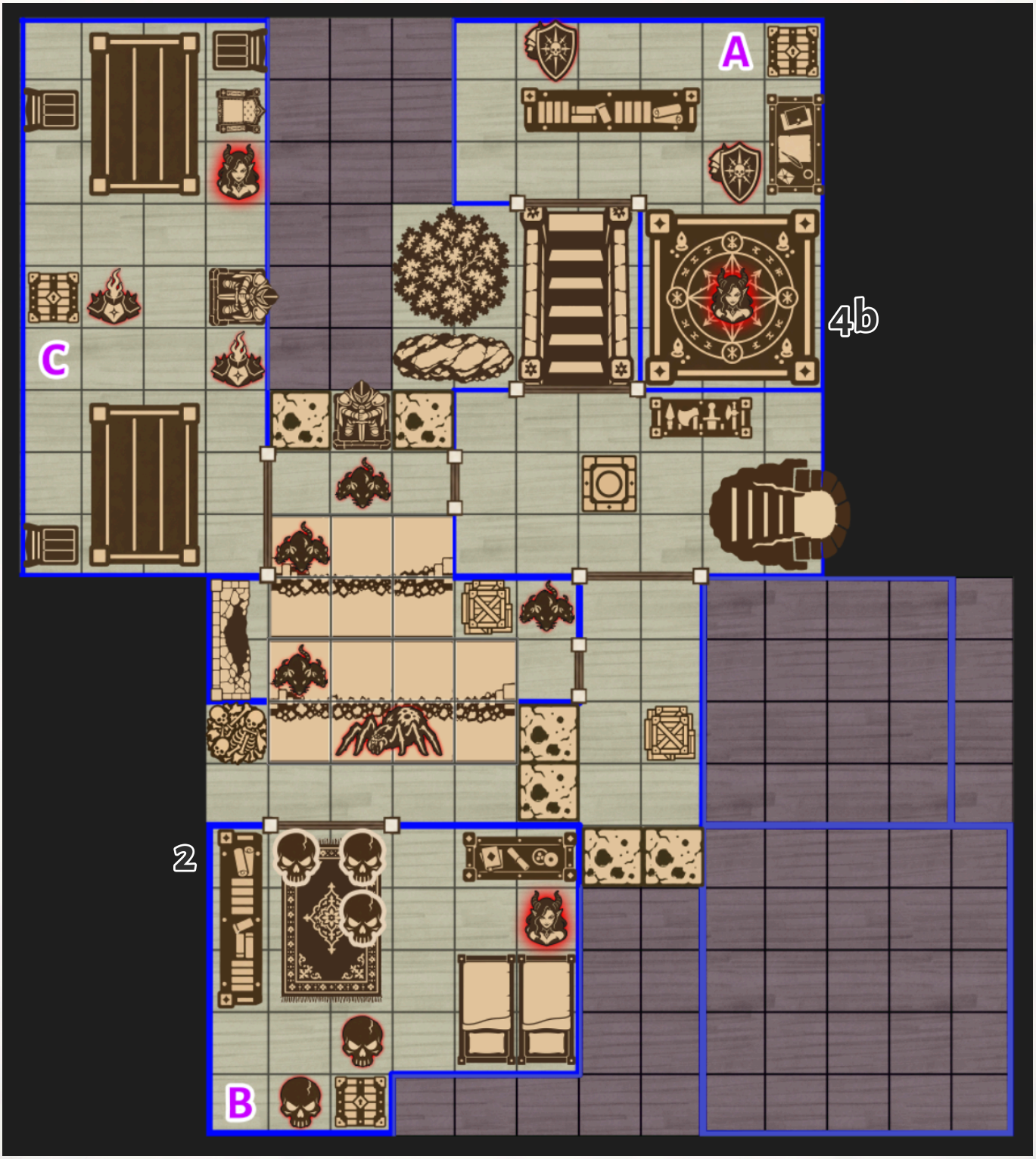
When he is killed, he drops **one fragment of the Seer Stone**, which is immediately considered to be in the party's possession.

Outro

With the three fragments of the Seer Stone recovered, you flee the Cathedral of Saint Venra as flames climb its broken towers.
Behind you, stained glass bursts in the heat, and holy banners blacken in the smoke. What once stood as a symbol of faith and order now burns against the night sky.
You have claimed the relic, but the sight follows you on the road back to court: even the sacred places of the realm are falling.

Adventure 6A: Loosening The Grip

Starting Doom Clock: 12
Resurrection Boons: 1



Intro

Sitilius stands over the restored Seer Stone, its three pieces bound together by a pale inner light.
"The dark influence upon King Arnewald that I discovered does not come from within the castle," he says, his face drawn with exhaustion. "The Stone has shown me its source: Baron Falkren's keep."
The baron's castle has fallen silent in recent weeks. Messengers do not return, servants have fled, and those still loyal to the baron speak with strange devotion. Sitilius believes a succubus has taken hold of the keep, twisting the baron and his court into willing servants.
"If she remains, the king's mind may never be freed," Sitilius says. "Enter the castle, slay the creature, and put down those who serve her corruption. Mercy will not reach them while her spell endures."
The road leads you to Baron Falkren's keep, where desire has rotted into obedience, and obedience into bloodshed.

Objective

The Succubus Mortatia must be slain.

Special Mechanic - House of Mirrors

Each room marked with a Succubus figure is a Mortatia encounter. The **first two times** the heroes enter a room that would contain Mortatia, resolve a House of Mirrors encounter instead. On the third such room, place Mortatia herself.

For the House of Mirrors encounter, roll a **d8** to determine which of the noble ladies appears.
If a noble lady is rolled that has already been slain during the 1st encounter, re-roll.
For each of the ladies, use the succubus reference card and "Female Noble" standee to represent them.

Each of the ladies is a **boss with 35 Health**, and all of them have the **Legendary traits**, and are **immune to Stun and Daze**.
Depending on the lady that appears, the **major ability is overridden** and they gain **bonus traits**.

D8	Lady Spawned	Bonus Trait	Major Ability
1-2	**Lady Merelle, the Thorn Hostess**	Counter Attack	Roll a **d6 two times** at the end of her turns, and execute both: 1-2: **Cruel Invitation** - Pull the furthest two heroes 2 spaces towards her. 3-4: **Barbed Courtesy** - Causes Blast 3 around her. 5-6: **Shielded By Devotion** - Spawn a Corrupted adjacent to her.
3-4	**Lady Ysara, the Perfumed Widow**	Leader Overpowering	Roll a **d6** at the end of her turns: 1-2: **Sweet Perfume** - Every hero within Range 3 suffers 1 Fatigue. 3-4: **Poisoned Pin** - Targets the furthest hero in Range 4. They suffer Decay 3. 5-6: **Widow's Step** - Move 4 towards the furthest hero, then performs a bonus attack (as per usual target priority).

5-6	**Lady Odrienne, the Mirror Bride**	Unpredictable Vengeful	Roll a **d6** at the end of her turns: 1-2: **Mirror Image** - Causes Blast 2, then teleports to the furthest space within Range 7. 3-4: **Shattered Glamour** - All heroes within Range 6 lose 2 Stamina. 5-6: **Painful Reflection** - Until the end of her next turn, each attack or ability against her causes Decay 1 to the attacker.
7-8	**Lady Caletha, the Red Confessor**	Powerful	Roll a **d6** at the end of her turns: 1-2: **Confession of Guilt** - Until the end of her next turn, the armor of all heroes is one step worse. 3-4: **Spellbreak** - Ends all ongoing active effects (including summons) from Arcane, Elemental or Dark Arts abilities. 5-6: **Blood Oath** - Causes all other enemies to lose 1 Health and heals the total dealt on herself. Re-roll if she is at full health.

Only on the third encounter of the Succubus it is actually Mortatia.
Succubus Mortatia is a **bespoke boss** and gains the **Protected trait**.

She only has a single phase with the following boss abilities:

Phase 1

Chain Pull, Touch of Ruin, Kiss of the Succubus, Beguiling Command.

As soon as she **banished her first card**, spawn **Baron Falkren** and **3 Corrupted** within Range 5 of her.

As soon as she **banished her second card**, spawn **3 Nameless Demons** within Range 5 of her.

Baron Falkren is a **boss**. Use the Blackguard reference card and the “Noble Male” standee to represent him. He has the **Enduring trait**.

Rewards

Stars	Requirement	XP Reward	Gold Reward
★★★	Doom Clock at 3+ upon completion.	5	175 *
★★	Doom Clock at 1+ upon completion.	4	150
★	Adventure completed.	3	125

* At this reward level, the party additionally gains a **Random Rare Affix**.

Adventure Overview

- A -

For the Succubus in this room, resolve the "House Of Mirrors" mechanic.

For the treasure chest, roll a d6 upon opening it to determine its contents:

1-2 **A trap!** The opening hero loses 3 Health.
3-4 **15 Gold Coins**
5-6 A scroll with a **Rare affix** of the party's choice. Apply it to any one item.

- B -

For the Succubus in this room, resolve the "House Of Mirrors" mechanic.

The treasure chest contains a tome, allowing one hero to immediately obtain **+1 XP**.

- C -

For the Succubus in this room, resolve the "House Of Mirrors" mechanic.

The treasure chest contains a **random Mythic affix**.
Draw from the pile of affixes until a **Mythic** affix is revealed. Then apply it to any one item.

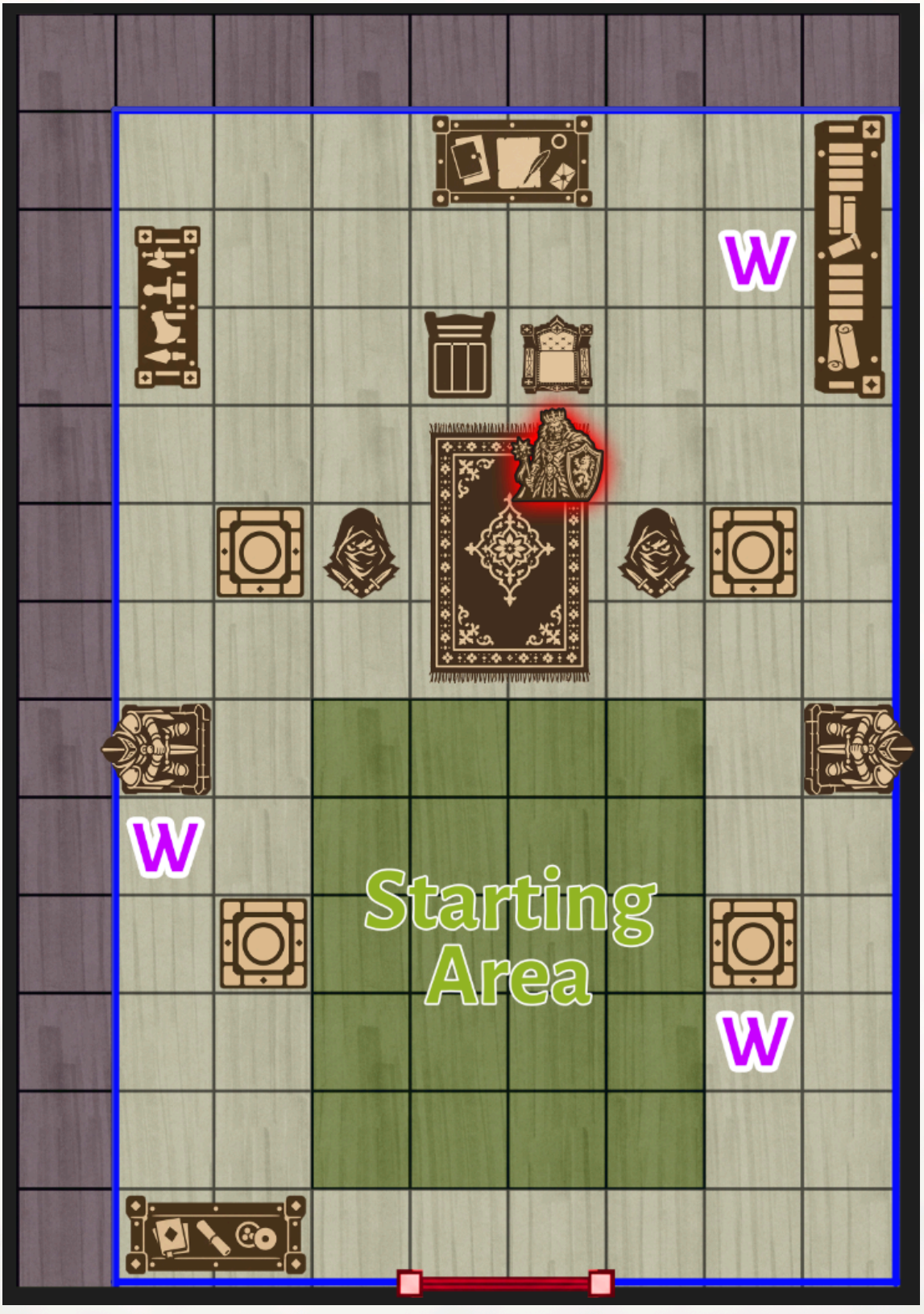
Outro

Mortatia's final scream fades into the stones of Baron Falkren's keep.
The spell over the castle breaks like glass. Servants wake from devotion into horror, guards lower their weapons, and the surviving nobles stare at the ruin around them as if seeing it for the first time.
Yet when you return to Sitilius, the restored Seer Stone still glows with a troubled light.
"The source is severed," he says, his voice heavy. "But the curse remains tangled in the king's mind. We have loosened its grip, not broken it."
He looks toward the throne room doors: "To free Arnewald, we must face him directly."

Adventure 7A: The Falling Crown

Starting Doom Clock: 9
Resurrection Boons: 3

3b



Intro

Sitilius leads you through a hidden passage beneath the royal castle, the restored Seer Stone wrapped in cloth and held tightly against his chest.

"The succubus' grip has weakened," he whispers, "but the curse still clings to Arnewald's mind. If we wait, it will sink its claws deeper. If we strike too hard, we may lose the king forever."

At last, you emerge near the throne room. Beyond the doors, King Arnewald's voice echoes through the hall, sharp and commanding. Loyal guards stand ready, and soldiers of the crown gather to defend their ruler from any who would oppose him. Sitilius looks to you, pale but resolute.
"Keep him occupied. Hurt him if you must, but do not kill him. I will set the cleansing wards and tear the darkness from him."
The throne room doors open.
King Arnewald turns toward you, his crown casting a long shadow across his face.
"Traitors," he says. "You come for me at last."

Objective

King Arnewald the Mad must be subdued so that Sitilius and the court mages can cleanse him.
If Sitilius dies, the campaign is lost.

Starting Conditions

The players can place themselves and Sitilius anywhere in the starting area when the adventure begins. The red locked door is the throne room entrance and will be used as the "Dungeon Entrance" to determine the activation order of enemies.

Place King Arnewald and two initial Soldiers (see "Loyalists" section) near him as indicated.

The "W" labels indicate viable positions for the wards to be installed (see "Cleansing Wards" section).

Special Mechanic - The Mad King

In this adventure, the party is engaging King Arnewald and his blindly loyal guards and soldiers.
He is protected by a demonic curse that also puts him under the maddening influence.

King Arnewald is a **bespoke boss**.

He has two phases with the following boss abilities:

Phase 1

Archers - Fire!, Voice of the Crown, Flailing Strike, Protect your King!

Phase 2

Archers - Fire!, Royal Command, The King's Mace, Crushing Strike
Add **Flailing Strike** again when playing at **campaign difficulty 3+.**

King Arnewald is under a demonic protection. He cannot be defeated unless all three wards have been activated! If something would normally defeat him but not all three wards are active, instead ignore that source of damage.

Special Mechanic: Loyalists

This adventure uses two unique enemy types: **Guards and Soldiers**.

Guards use the Blackguard reference card and standee.

Soldiers use the Corrupted reference card, but are represented by Bandit standees.
Soldiers are considered Human, not Demon. They have the **Incompetent, Fast, and Ranged traits**.

If new loyalists should spawn but the required enemy supply is empty, spawn as many as possible and skip the rest.

Special Mechanic: Cleansing Wards

To help break the king's influence, Sitilius accompanies the party as a minion. Determine initially who controls him.

Sitilius has 20 Health, 5 Speed, 3d6 Offense, and 5+ Armor.

Instead of attacking, Sitilius may use his action while standing on a designated ward location to work on that ward. The first time Sitilius uses this action at a ward location, place an objective token there representing a ward. The ward is now prepared, but not yet active.
The second time Sitilius uses this action at the same ward location, the ward becomes active.
Wards can at no point be destroyed by enemies.

Whenever a ward becomes active, spawn loyalists at the throne room entrance based on which ward was activated:

First Ward:	1 Guard and 3 Soldiers
Second Ward:	2 Guards and 4 Soldiers
Third Ward:	2 Guards and 5 Soldiers. In this last wave, all Loyalists gain the **Dangerous and Brutal traits**.

Rewards

Stars	Requirement	XP Reward	Gold Reward
★★★	Doom Clock at 1+ upon completion and at least 2 Loyalists were left alive at the end.	-	-
★★	Doom Clock at 1+ upon completion.	-	-
★	Adventure completed.	-	-

This adventure grants no rewards, as the campaign ends and the heroes retire afterwards.
Star results may only be relevant for certain Campaign Quests or personal satisfaction.

Outro

The final ward flares with blinding light.
King Arnewald falls to his knees, the darkness around him twisting like smoke caught in a storm. For a moment, his voice is not his own. It shrieks through the throne room, full of hatred, hunger, and ancient spite.
Then it is gone.
The king collapses, breathing but broken. Sitilius lowers his hands, trembling from the strain of the ritual.
Around you, the surviving loyalists stare in silence, their weapons lowered, their certainty shattered.
When Arnewald finally opens his eyes, there is fear in them, and shame.
"What have I done?" he whispers.
No one answers.
Beyond the shattered windows, dawn touches the castle walls. The realm still bleeds, and most wounds will not heal quickly. But for the first time in many dark days, the crown is free.

Campaign End + Court Enchanter

You have finished this campaign. Check which campaign quests you completed and gain their rewards for future campaign playthroughs.

Additionally, if this is the first time you have cleansed the maddened king, unlock the **Court Enchanter** for all future playthroughs.

From now on, during each Town Phase, the party may use the **Court Enchanter's services** at any point.

When using the Court Enchanter, draw and reveal **three affixes**. The party may buy one of these affixes and attach them to items they own. Discard the rest and shuffle them back into the pile of affixes.

Rare Affixes cost 20 Gold Coins.
Epic Affixes cost 40 Gold Coins.
Mythic Affixes cost 60 Gold Coins.